

TYPES OF QUALITATIVE RESEARCH



DR. DEEPIKA RAJAWAT

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR

DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION

THE MAHARAJA SAYAJIRAO UNIVERSITY OF BARODA

deepika.rajawat-case@msubaroda.ac.in

QUALITATIVE RESEARCH: KEY FEATURES

1. QUALITATIVE STUDIES AIM TO PROVIDE UNDERSTANDING OF COMPLEX PSYCHOSOCIAL ISSUES. MOST USEFUL FOR ANSWERING 'WHY?' AND 'HOW?' QUESTIONS.
2. FLEXIBLE RESEARCH DESIGN AND AN ITERATIVE, CYCLICAL APPROACH TO SAMPLING, DATA COLLECTION, ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION.
3. PURPOSE. REACH PEOPLE WHO CAN SHARE THEIR UNIQUE SLICE OF REALITY, SUCH THAT THE SLICES ILLUSTRATE THE RANGE OF VARIATION IN THE STUDY AREA (ELMUSHARAF, 2021).
4. FOCUS ON: DEPTH VS BREADTH
5. SATURATION RATHER THAN GENERALIZABILITY
6. QUALITY OF EXPERIENCES, RATHER THAN QUANTITY

COMPARED TO THE QUANTITATIVE RESEARCH, THE SAMPLING PROCEDURES IN QUALITATIVE RESEARCH ARE NOT WELL DEFINED.

Qualitative Research Methods Comparison					
Aspect	Grounded Theory	Phenomenology	Ethnography	Case Study	Narrative Research
Definition	Develops a theory based on data collected from participants.	Explores lived experiences of individuals.	Studies cultural groups and their behaviors.	Investigates a single case (individual, group, or event) in depth.	Examines and interprets personal stories and experiences.
Purpose	To generate new theories grounded in real-world data.	To understand how people experience a phenomenon.	To describe and analyze cultural practices and social behaviors.	To provide in-depth understanding of a particular case.	To explore personal stories and how people construct meaning.
Data Collection	Interviews, observations, open-ended surveys, constant comparative method.	In-depth interviews, personal reflections, diaries.	Participant observation, field notes, interviews, artifacts.	Multiple sources (interviews, documents, observations, reports).	Interviews, autobiographies, life stories, letters, diaries.

Qualitative Research Methods Comparison					
Aspect	Grounded Theory	Phenomenology	Ethnography	Case Study	Narrative Research
Analysis	Coding, constant comparison, category formation, theory building.	Identifying themes and meanings in lived experiences.	Thematic and contextual analysis of cultural patterns.	Thematic and descriptive analysis, pattern identification.	Chronological, thematic, or structural analysis of narratives.
Focus	Developing theory based on participant experiences.	Understanding human experiences and perceptions.	Understanding cultural context and social behaviors.	In-depth exploration of a specific case or cases.	Personal stories and their significance in a social or cultural context.
Example Studies	A study developing a theory on how cancer patients cope with diagnosis.	A study on the lived experiences of survivors of domestic violence.	Research on tribal customs and traditions in indigenous communities.	A case study on the effects of online learning on a specific school.	Life stories of immigrants adjusting to a new country.

Qualitative approaches to research are based on a real "worldview" which is holistic (a view that an organic or integrated whole has a reality independent of and greater than the sum of its parts) and has the following beliefs:

- There is not a single reality for each person. It changes over time.
- What we know has meaning only within a given situation or context. The reasoning process used in qualitative research involves perceptually putting pieces together to make wholes.
- Reality based upon perceptions are different. From this process meaning is produced. However, because perception varies with the individual, many different meanings are possible.
- A qualitative research technique which aims to understand, identify and describe a phenomena by how the experience is perceived by its members is objective study of subjective things (phenomena).

PHENOMENOLOGY

PHENOMENOLOGY

- Defined as “a method in philosophy that begins with the individual and his own conscious experience and tries to avoid prior assumptions, prejudices, and philosophical dogmas”. (authoritative principles or tenets accepted as true without proof)
- (Immanuel Kant famously critiqued traditional metaphysics for being dogmatic)
- A phenomenological approach to qualitative research study wants to focus on describing the meaning for many individuals of their combined lived experience of a single aspect, concept, or simply phenomenon.
- Phenomenology examines phenomena as they are apprehended in their immediacy by the social actor.
- Phenomenologists study how people define their social situations once they have suspended or “bracketed” ((epoche)-the practice of deliberately suspending preconceived notions and cultural biases) their learned cultural notions.
- The basic proposition states that everyday reality is a socially constructed system of ideas that has accumulated overtime and is taken for granted by group members.
- Phenomenology made inroads through ethnomethodology- Garfinkel (1967)

EDMUND HUSSERL

Phenomenology was founded at the beginning of the twentieth century by Edmund Husserl (1859-1938).

According to Husserl:

- ☐ *Philosophical analysis should turn to the things themselves*
- ☐ *The next question was: what are the things themselves? How to perceive and conceive them? (This is what phenomenology, the science of phenomena).*
- ☐ *Started his analysis with subjective consciousness; the locus of cognition with the best of evidence, there is no cognition without consciousness*
- ☐ *To understand Subjective Consciousness we need to understand Kriegel's self representational theory. (As per Kriegel Consciousness has two components: Subjective Character and Qualitative Character)*
- ☐ *A mental state as a conscious experience can be divided into two components: what Kriegel calls its "subjective character" (I called it "subjectivity") and its "qualitative character". One way to get at the distinction is by way of the standard "what it's like" locution. When we say that there is something it is like for me to see a ripe tomato on the kitchen counter in daylight, that there is something at all it is like for me is the subjective character, and precisely what it is like for me (properties) is the qualitative character. All conscious experiences share subjective character, but they differ in their qualitative character.*

- ❑ *Subjective consciousness is always a consciousness of something*
- ❑ *Qualitative character is the “sensory feel” the unique sensory, emotional, or cognitive flavor of the phenomenon.*
- ❑ *Methods to phenomenological analysis:*
 - *Free imaginative variation (finding the essence of phenomena)*
 - *Bracketing of the assumptions*
 - *Bracketing of existence of things-Transcendental reduction (Phenomenological reduction) -whatness of phenomena. (steps: phenomenological epoche-reduction to the given(what is directly presented in consciousness)-Intentional Analysis (Analyzing the relationship between the act of experiencing and the object being experienced)- Eidetic Reduction(Imagining variations of the experience to determine its essential, unchangeable features.*

MEANING OF 'ESSENCE' OF PHENOMENON

I can imagine all possible horses, large and small, fat and skinny, lazy *and* lively, brown, gray, and black, with long or short tails, and bushy or tiny manes. Even if these possible variations are endless, there is with Husserl's words, an original "model" there that guides the variations and sets its boundaries. For example, there is a "stop" when the horses in the example suddenly become donkeys, zebras, or toy horses. Thus, something *remains* throughout that "consciousness game," namely the essence, which makes a horse a horse and thus differentiates it from a donkey, a zebra, or a toy horse, may it be longer ears, certain stripes, certain feet or tails. Husserl explains:

MEANING OF 'ESSENCE' OF PHENOMENON

It then becomes evident that a unity runs through this multiplicity of successive figures, that in such free variations of an original image, e.g. of a thing, an *invariant* is necessarily retained as the *necessary general form*, without which an object such as this thing, as an example of this kind, would not be thinkable at all. (Husserl, [Citation1973](#), p. 341.)

- ❑ There is a general form of the phenomenon, Husserl says, an essential meaning or essence to the phenomenon, which makes the phenomenon what it is. If the essential meaning changes in a certain way, it is a different phenomenon.
- ❑ Phenomenal consciousness, according to Kriegel, is that feature of mental life that is responsible for the "explanatory gap" (Levine 1983)

ALFRED SCHUTZ

- He introduced Phenomenology into Sociology.
- Two pillars in Methodology of social sciences (Logic of Scientific explanation and Constitutive analysis of the social world- Schutz emphasizes on the later).
- His writings were concerned with Weber's Verstehen. Weber overlooked that the modes of givenness of social actions- and therefore their meanings- are different to the actor himself (1) Observer in everyday life (2) and to social scientist (3)
- He focuses on an aspect of social world called *-life-world* or the world of everyday life which is intersubjective in which people both create social reality and are constrained by the pre-existing social and cultural structures created by their predecessors.
- Schutz was concerned with the dialectical relationship between the way people construct social reality and the obdurate social and cultural reality that they inherit from those who preceded them in the social world.
- Schutz's view: the constructs that people use in order to render the world meaningful and intelligible to them as the key focus of a phenomenologically grounded social science.

CENTRAL FOCUS OF PHENOMENOLOGY

- ❑ People and their social reality—is fundamentally different from the subject matter of the natural sciences- rejection of the positivist position
- ❑ Understanding of social reality must be grounded in people's experience of that social reality. Failure to recognize and encapsulate the meaningful nature of everyday experience runs the risk of losing touch with social reality and imposing instead 'a fictional non-existing world constructed by the scientific observer'
- ❑ Phenomenology is concerned with the subjective experience, which is considered to be more real and more important in the understanding of human nature and human experience. It focuses on the person's lived experience within a phenomenon, including shared meanings and commonalities.
- ❑ Phenomenologists view the person as integral with the environment. The focus of phenomenological research is people's experience in regard to a phenomenon and how they interpret their experiences. All phenomenologists agree that there is not a single reality; each individual has his or her own reality. This is considered true even of the researcher's experience in collecting data and analyzing it. There are four aspects of the human experience, which are of interest to the phenomenological researcher: Lived space (spatiality), Lived body (corporeality), Lived human relationships (relationality), Lived time (temporality). All of these aspects are taken into consideration, hence, people see different realities in different situations, in the company of different people and at different times.

Methodology in Phenomenology

- ❑ Most data collected in phenomenology are in the form of language that includes methods such as accounts of conversations, group dialogue, diary, autobiography, and personal narratives.
- ❑ Interviews remain the most common means of collecting data in phenomenology.
- ❑ Also used research methods include: conceptual analysis; linguistic analysis; hermeneutical method and praxis; historical-critical method; literary philosophy; and formal logic
- ❑ Collection of data from participants who have experienced the phenomenon. This is accomplished by observations, interactive interviews, videotapes and written descriptions by the subject participants.
- ❑ Composite description of the essence of the experience by all of the individual participants ("what" they experienced & "how" they experienced the phenomenon).
- ❑ In most instances data is collected through in-depth interactive conversations between the researcher and the participant. (B.B. Mohanty)

THE ETHNOGRAPHY

THE ETHNOGRAPHY

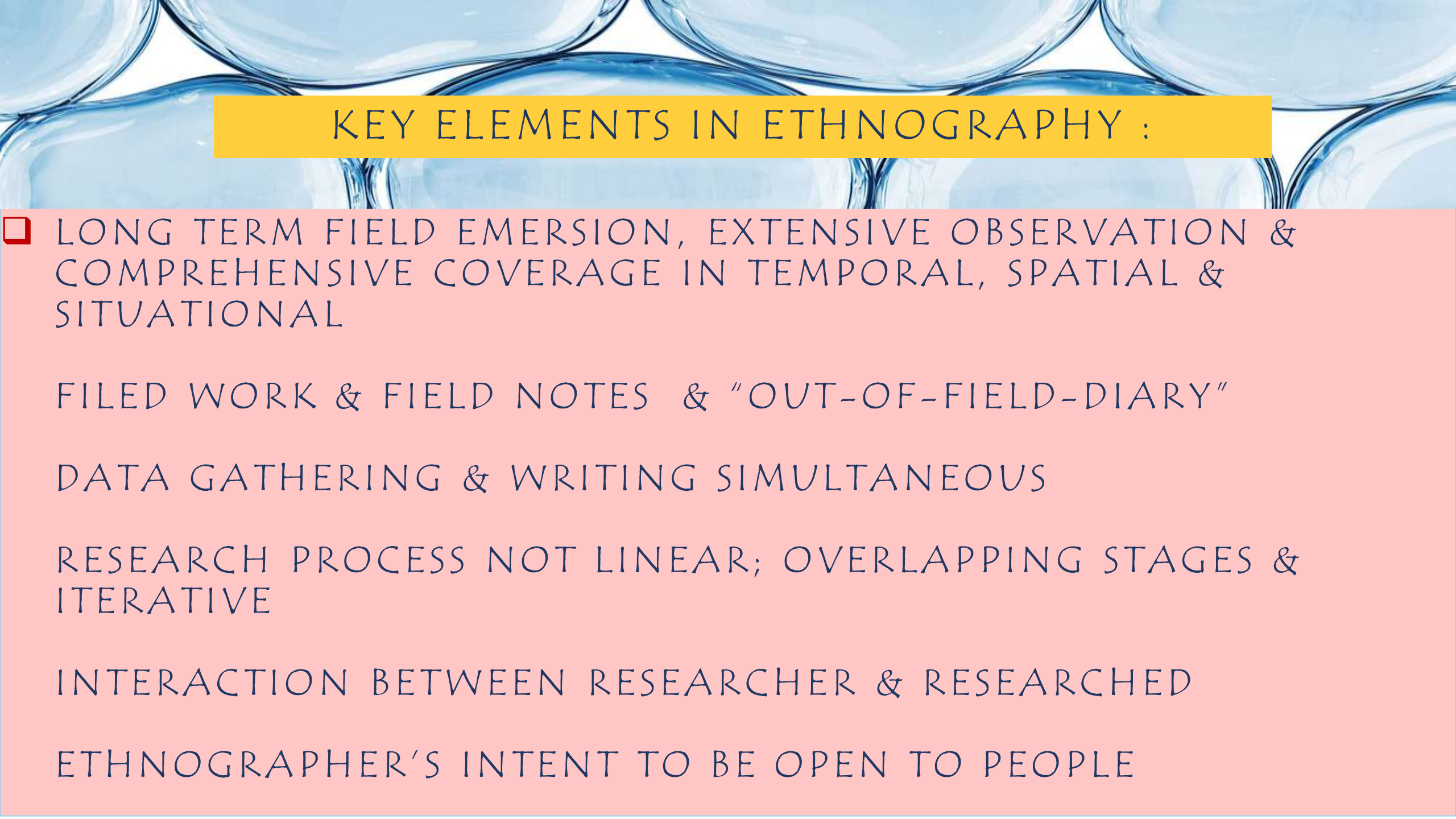
STUDY OF A CULTURAL GROUP/SOCIAL SUB-GROUP

*FOCUS: OBSERVABLE SHARED PATTERN OF
BEHAVIOUR & LIFE PRACTICES ; MEANINGS OF
SUCH BEHAVIOUR, LANGUAGE AND INTERACTION)*

*VARIANTS: REALIST ETHNOGRAPHY VS CRITICAL
ETHNOGRAPHY FOCUS STRUCTURE*

Feature	Realist Ethnography	Critical Ethnography
Definition	A traditional, objective approach that aims to describe a culture or social group as accurately as possible.	A politically engaged approach that critiques power structures and advocates for marginalized groups.
Philosophical Basis	Positivist/post-positivist (objective reality can be studied and described).	Critical theory (knowledge is shaped by power relations and should challenge oppression).
Researcher's Role	Observer and recorder, striving for neutrality and detachment.	Active participant and advocate for social change.
Perspective	Emphasizes factual representation without researcher bias.	Acknowledges the researcher's bias and subjectivity.

Feature	Realist Ethnography	Critical Ethnography
Purpose	To document and explain cultural patterns objectively.	To challenge inequalities and empower marginalized voices.
Data Collection	Uses traditional ethnographic methods like participant observation and interviews.	Uses similar methods but with a focus on exposing power dynamics and social injustices.
Focus	Descriptive and explanatory; presents an insider view of culture.	Emancipatory and transformative; seeks to critique and reform society.
Example Studies	Studies documenting rituals, traditions, or ways of life in a specific culture.	Studies analyzing racism, gender inequality, or class struggles within cultural settings.



KEY ELEMENTS IN ETHNOGRAPHY :

❑ LONG TERM FIELD EMERSION, EXTENSIVE OBSERVATION & COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE IN TEMPORAL, SPATIAL & SITUATIONAL

FILED WORK & FIELD NOTES & "OUT-OF-FIELD-DIARY"

DATA GATHERING & WRITING SIMULTANEOUS

RESEARCH PROCESS NOT LINEAR; OVERLAPPING STAGES & ITERATIVE

INTERACTION BETWEEN RESEARCHER & RESEARCHED

ETHNOGRAPHER'S INTENT TO BE OPEN TO PEOPLE

CASE STUDY

CASE STUDY :

❑ CASE STUDY RESEARCH METHODOLOGY IS PHILOSOPHICALLY NEUTRAL, ALLOWING IT TO BE USED IN QUANTITATIVE, MIXED METHODS, AND QUALITATIVE RESEARCH PROJECTS (HARRISON ET AL., 2017; STAKE, 1995).

IN QUALITATIVE RESEARCH, CASE STUDY IS USED TO EXAMINE A BOUNDED PHENOMENON INTENSIVELY AND HOLISTICALLY WITHIN THE CONTEXTS AND SITUATIONS AS THEY OCCUR IN REAL-LIFE FROM THE PERSPECTIVES OF THOSE WITHIN IT (MERRIAM, 2009; STAKE, 1995). MERRIAM (2009).

CASE STUDIES, IN THEIR TRUE ESSENCE, EXPLORE AND INVESTIGATE CONTEMPORARY REAL-LIFE PHENOMENON THROUGH DETAILED CONTEXTUAL ANALYSIS OF A LIMITED NUMBER OF EVENTS OR CONDITIONS AND THEIR RELATIONSHIPS (ZAINAL, 2007).

A Case study is an empirical enquiry that

- *Investigates a contemporary phenomenon in depth and within its real-life context, especially when*

- *The boundaries between phenomenon and context are not clearly evident.*

➤ *The Case Study inquiry copes with the technically distinctive situation in which there will be many more variables of interest than data points, and as one result relies on multiple sources of evidence, with data needing to coverage in triangular fashion, and as another result benefits from the prior development of theoretical propositions to guide data collection and analysis*



REASONS OF USING CASE STUDY

- ❑ *Exploration and Description*
- ❑ *Theory Building, theory testing, theory extension*
- ❑ *Hypothesis building and testing*

(Dul & Hak, 2008, Stake, 1995; Yin, 1994, Voss et al., 2002)



TYPES OF CASE STUDY

- ❑ **Intrinsic Case Study:** to understand a specific individual or situation. The Case is unusual and has merit in study. The Case itself is of interest. (Single Case Study)
- ❑ **Instrumental Case Study:** to understand something more than just a particular case. When the focus is of a specific issue and a case is used to illustrate the issue.
- ❑ **Multiple or collective:** Studies multiple cases at the same time. Multiple cases are described and compared to provide insight into an issue.
- ❑ **Problem oriented:** Understanding the Problem and Finding actions

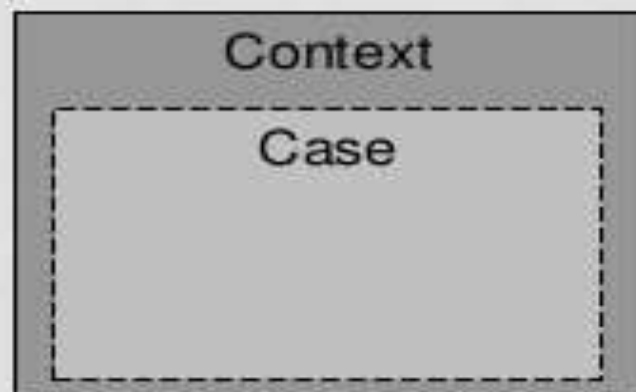
Other Types: Exploratory, Explanatory, Descriptive, Comparative Case Study, Evaluative Case Studies (Dul & Hak, 2008, Stake, 1995; Yin, 1993, Zainal, 2007)

CASE STUDY METHODOLOGY

- ❑ *Design the case study, Conduct the case study, analyse the case study evidence, Develop the conclusion, recommendation and implication. (Yin, 1995; Tellis, 1997)*
- ❑ *Conduct a literature review, Construct a theoretical framework, Identifying a research problem, Crafting and shaping research questions, Select the sample (Merriam, 1998)*
- ❑ *Define the research framework, constructs and questions, Choosing Cases, Developing instruments and protocols, conducting the field research, analysis (Voss et al., 2002)*
- ❑ *Preparation phase and research phase along with implications (Dul and Hak, 2008)*

BASIC TYPES OF DESIGNS

Single-case Designs



Holistic
(single unit
of analysis)

Context

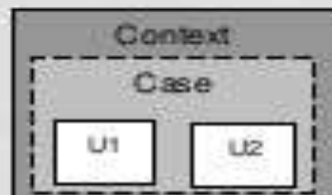
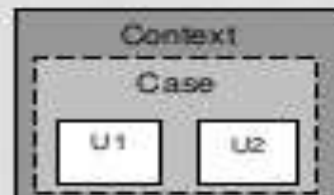
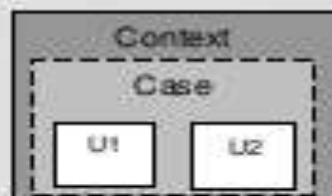
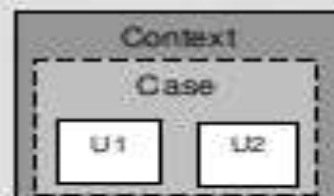
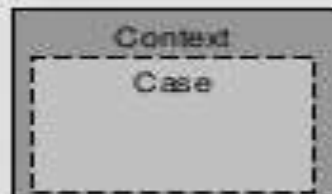
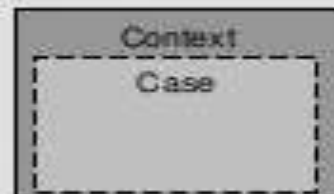
Case

Embedded
Unit of
Analysis 1

Embedded
Unit of
Analysis 2

Embedded
(multiple units
of analysis)

Multiple-case Designs



DATA GATHERING METHODS

- *Use Multiple sources of data*
- *Document review and analysis*
- *Archival records: Historical Evidence*
- *Interview- Formal, Semi-structured, In-depth,*
- *Observation- Direct and indirect*
- *Meeting*
- *Participatory observation*
- *Focus group Discussion*
- *Physical Artifact: man-made object that has some kind of cultural significance*
- *Photo, video*
- *Create a Case Study database*
- *Maintain a Chain of Evidence*

(Dul & Hak, 2008, Stake, 1995; Yin, 1993)

DATA ANALYSIS IN CASE

- ☐ Individual Case History
- ☐ Data Reduction and Data Display
- ☐ Triangulation of different sources
- ☐ Categorical Aggregation
- ☐ Constant comparison
- ☐ Pattern matching
- ☐ Narrative analysis and Time series analysis
- ☐ Logical models -cause effect relations
- ☐ Cross case synthesis
- ☐ Conclusion Drawing and Verification
- ☐ Content Analysis
- ☐ Analytic Induction
- ☐ Within Case Analysis
- ☐ Visual Inspection

(Stake, 1995; Yin, 1993, Huberman & Miles, 1994, Yazan, 2025)

GROUND THEORY

KEY CONSIDERATIONS IN GROUNDED THEORY:

■ GENERATING THEORY FROM DATA

FOCUS: EXPLAINING AN ACTION, INTERACTION OR A PROCESS IN TERMS OF AN ABSTRACT ANALYTICAL SCHEMA OF A PHENOMENA OR UNDERLYING THEORY

EG. HOW DO SOME FACULTY BECOME GOOD RESEARCHER?
IN OPERATIONAL TERMS GT INVOLVES
"IDENTIFICATION OF AN ARRAY OF IDEAS/THEMES TO
CONSTITUTE A BROAD GENERALIZATION THAT EXPLAINS
& DESCRIBE A SET OF DATA"

EXPERIENCE WITH DATA GENERATES INSIGHT,
HYPOTHESES & GENERATIVE QUESTIONS THAT ARE
PURSUED THROUGH FURTHER DATA ANALYSIS.

Dr. DEE

Variants: 3 variants based upon Epistemic Assumptions

Positivist by Barney Glaser	Post-Positivist Anselm Strauss & Corbin	Social Constructivist by Bryant & Charmaz
Truth independent of research context; Neutral Observer	Truth situated in the socio-cultural context Neutral Observer	Relative & multiple Truth; Researcher & Researched mutually created
Inductive classification & coding, constant comparison of categories , deductive application until clear themes fitting data	Data interpreted in terms of rule based prescriptive categories; Glaser labeled it as in contradictory to GT	Data Interpretation through Heuristic Exploration of Categories

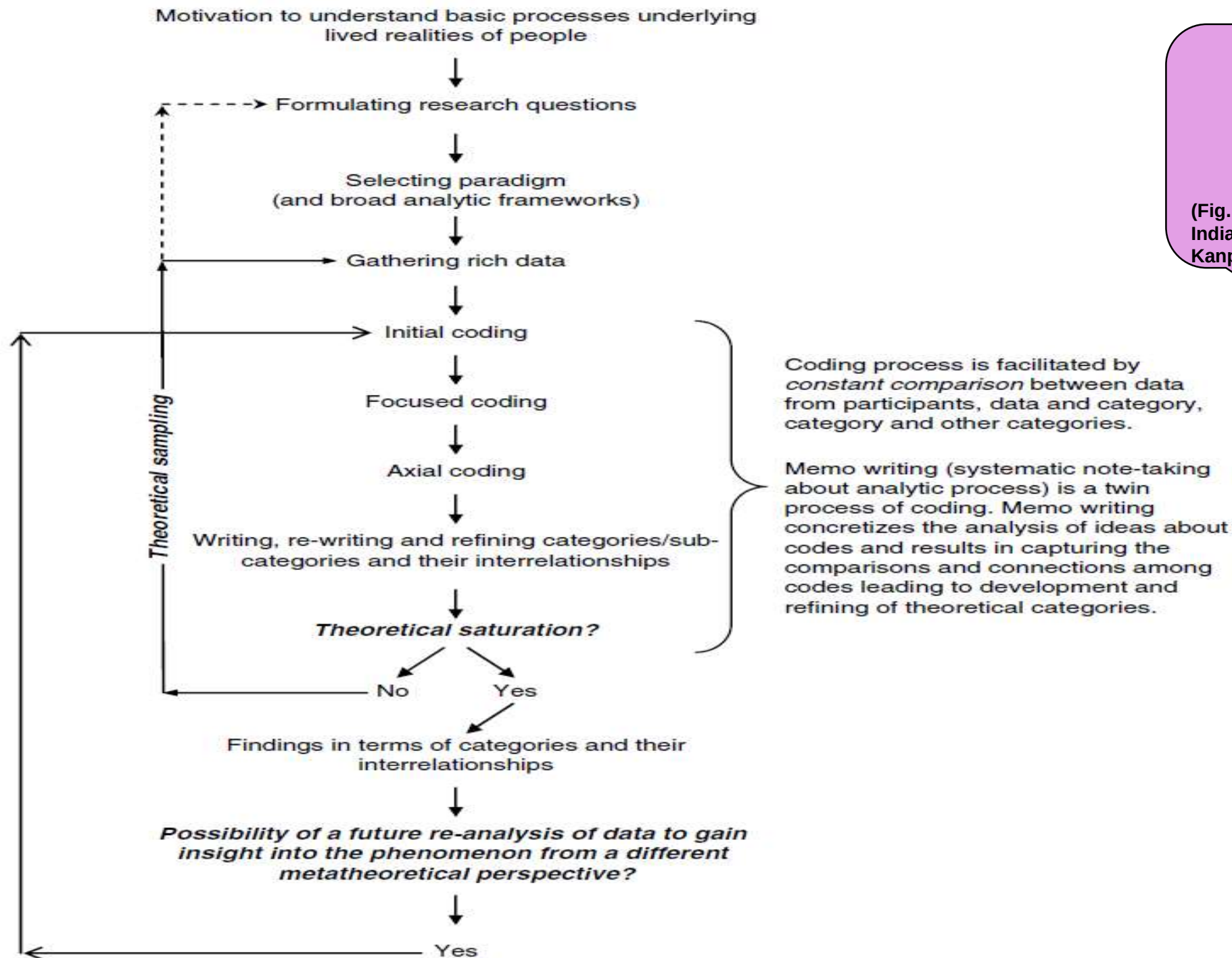
KEY CONSIDERATIONS IN GROUNDED THEORY:

KEY ELEMENTS :

- ❑ NO PRECONCEIVED THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK
- ❑ EMERGENT RESEARCH DESIGN
- ❑ THEORY FROM GROUND [PARTICIPANTS' MEANINGS]
- ❑ MEMOING WITH THEORETICAL SENSITIVITY
- ❑ DATA GATHERING & ANALYSIS SIMULTANEOUSLY
- ❑ ITERATIVE PROCESS OF THEORIZATON
- ❑ OPEN CODING & CONSTANT COMPARISON TO EMERGE EXPLANATORY THEMES
- ❑ THEORETICAL & DISCRIMINANT SAMPLING [TO TEST THEORETICAL SATURATION]

General Procedure in GTM

(Fig. Kumar Ravi Priya
Indian Institute of Technology
Kanpur , India)



Theoretical sampling

The origin of theoretical sampling goes back to the discovery of grounded theory method (glaser & strauss, 1967). Theoretical sampling technique is developed as A rigorous method employing which qualitative data can be captured to develop A new theory (glaser & strauss, 1967).

It is defined as the sampling process by which data can be collected to develop A theory whereby the researcher 'collects, codes, and analyses his data and decides which data to collect next and where to find them, in order to develop his theory as it emerges' (glaser, 1978, P. 36).

- ❑ The process of data collection through theoretical sampling method is controlled by the emerging theory and not by any other variables (coyne, 1997).
- ❑ The selection of respondents in theoretical sampling depends on the theory and groups are chosen as and when they are needed rather than before the research begins. That is the sample in this technique is not selected from a population on the basis of some variables prior to the study. Rather 'the initial sample is determined to examine the phenomena where it is found to exist' (chenitz & swanson, 1986, P. 9).
- ❑ The initial stage of theoretical sampling resembles the purposeful sampling as researcher visit the groups which they believe will maximize the possibilities of obtaining data and leads to more data on their question. The theoretical sampling method facilitates researcher to collect, codes, and analyses data simultaneously in order to decide what data to collect next (shaheen, gupta, & kumar, 2016).

NARRATIVE ANALYSIS

FOCUS: Aims at narrative explanations of how a person's life experiences, its ontological, epistemological & ideological elements in interaction with sociocultural elements influenced development of the individual.

Narrative inquiry looks into the complexities of life experiences consisting of the tensions and contradictions with individual's life experiences

Variants: biography, life history, teacher-student narrative & theory oriented narrative

Key Elements :

- ❑ Researcher as a Learner
- ❑ Individual's Life Experiences as Episodes
- ❑ Individual's Personal Reflection as "Field Text"
- ❑ 3 Steps: Constructing, Deconstructing & Reconstructing

Construction : Episodes are gathered by informal talks & interviews

Deconstruction:

- ❑ Identify individual's voice & vision, tension & contradictions,;
- ❑ Time, place, character, plot & scene & as embedded in sociocultural context

Reconstruction: Retelling of the lived in experiences of the individual chronologically portraying the shaping of the individual through the

QUESTIONS TO PONDER UPON?

What is the role of 'Consciousness' and 'Essence' in dealing with phenomenological research?

Differentiate between Realist Ethnography and Critical Ethnography.

What is the role of theoretical sampling in Grounded Theory?

How is sample size estimated in qualitative techniques?

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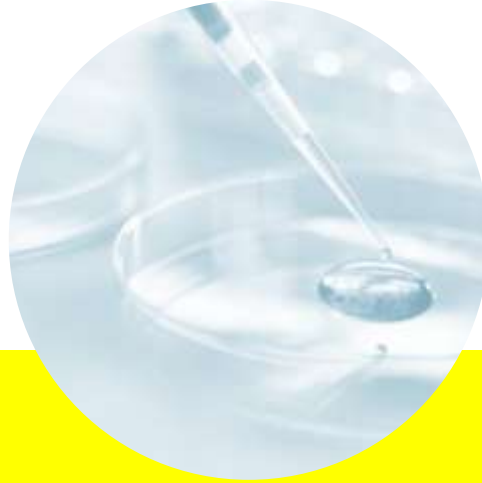
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RAJAWAT



DR. DEEPIKA RAJAWAT | ASSISTANT PROFESSOR | THE MAHARAJA UNIVERSITY OF
BARODA|

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THANK YOU

